To the Admissions Committee,

I am pleased to recommend Mr. Kandarp Solanki, who has been working with us at Axis Asset Management Company as a Research Associate in the equity investments team since July 2025. As Head of Equity at Axis AMC, I have interacted with him, particularly on coverage related to FinTech and IPO opportunities.

Axis AMC manages an extensive suite of active equity strategies with a sizeable AUM, and our standards for research quality are accordingly high. Kandarp joined us directly from IIT Bombay's Engineering Physics program. His primary coverage includes a part of the Indian FinTech space, a segment with a combined market capitalisation of over USD 100 billion, and he works along with a senior resource on building and maintaining detailed fundamental models and evaluating new listings.

On a day-to-day basis, his work involves doing fundamental equity research. As and when required, he has been part of the meetings with CEOs and CFOs of listed companies, where he has shown the ability to ask relevant questions. For someone so early in his career, his comfort level in these discussions is noteworthy.

In addition to the core valuation work, Kandarp has contributed to improving our internal processes. He developed automated routines in Python to track analyst performance across a model portfolio and to consolidate valuation metrics in real time. These tools have significantly reduced manual effort in our operations and improved the consistency of our internal tracking. This blend of quantitative skill and practical problem-solving is rare.

What I appreciate most about Kandarp is his composure and clarity. He is willing to dig into the details of a business model, Despite his young age, he has already had exposure to responsibilities and conversations.

I believe a rigorous master's program in Financial Engineering will further refine his already strong analytical base and provide him with a broader toolkit in quantitative finance. He has both the intellect and the temperament to benefit from and contribute to such a program. I recommend him and wish him all the best in his career.

Sincerely,

Axis Asset Management Company Ltd. ★ Mumbai

Mr. Shreyash Devalkar
Head of Equity
Axis Asset Management Company Limited